

Generative AI & AI Tools Usage Policy

1. Purpose

This policy establishes rules for the responsible use of generative artificial intelligence (AI) tools and AI-assisted software at Summit IT Services. Generative AI tools offer significant productivity benefits but also introduce risks including data leakage, copyright exposure, inaccurate outputs, and regulatory compliance concerns. This policy ensures employees can benefit from approved AI tools while protecting Summit IT Services' data, clients, and reputation.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees, contractors, interns, and temporary staff using AI tools in the course of Summit IT Services work.
- All generative AI tools, including large language model (LLM) assistants, AI image generators, AI code assistants, AI meeting transcription tools, and AI-integrated features within approved applications.
- Both standalone AI tools and AI features embedded in existing applications (e.g., Microsoft 365 Copilot, GitHub Copilot, Slack AI, Zoom AI Companion).
- Use on company-owned devices and personal devices when performing work for Summit IT Services.

3. Policy Statements

3.1 Approved AI Tools

3.1.1 Employees must use only IT-approved AI tools for work purposes. Using unapproved consumer AI services with company or client data is prohibited (see 3.3).

3.1.2 The following AI tools are approved at the time of this policy. The approved list is updated as tools are evaluated and will always reflect current approvals at <https://help.summitit.com/catalog/ai-tools>:

Tool	Approved Use Cases	Data Classification Allowed	Notes
Microsoft 365 Copilot	Drafting, summarizing, email, meeting notes, document generation	Up to and including Confidential	Enterprise agreement; data stays within M365 tenant

GitHub Copilot (Business)	Code completion, code generation, documentation	Internal / Confidential (no Restricted data in prompts)	Enabled for engineering roles only; code suggestions reviewed before use
Zoom AI Companion	Meeting summaries, action items, whiteboard assistance	Internal (meeting content)	Must disclose AI recording to all participants; consent required
Microsoft Copilot for Security	Security log analysis, threat intelligence queries	Confidential / Restricted (within Sentinel/Defender)	IT Security team only; runs within M365 compliance boundary

3.1.3 Employees who wish to use an AI tool not on the approved list must submit an "AI Tool Request" via SummitDesk. Requests are reviewed by IT Security for data privacy, vendor security posture, and terms of service before approval.

3.1.4 New AI features released within existing approved platforms (e.g., a new Copilot feature in Teams) must be reviewed by IT Security before employee use. IT will communicate approved features via the [#it-announcements](#) Slack channel.

3.2 Data Input Rules

The single most important principle for AI tool use is: **the classification of data you input determines whether you may use the tool.**

3.2.1 The following table governs what data may be entered into AI tool prompts, chat interfaces, or uploaded as context:

Data Classification	Can be entered into approved AI tools?	Notes
Public	Yes	No restrictions
Internal	Yes	Use only approved tools; do not use consumer AI
Confidential	Yes, in approved tools with Confidential clearance only	Must verify tool's data boundary before use; see tool table in 3.1.2
Restricted	No - prohibited in all AI tools unless specifically listed	No AI tool currently approved for Restricted data input

3.2.2 Restricted data must never be entered into any AI tool, including approved tools, without explicit written approval from IT Security & Compliance and Legal. This includes but is not limited to:

- Personal health information (PHI).
- Social Security numbers, financial account numbers, or payment card data.
- Employee personal data beyond first name.
- Client personal data subject to GDPR, CCPA, HIPAA, or other regulation.
- Authentication credentials, API keys, or encryption keys.
- Mergers & acquisitions (M&A) information under NDA.

3.2.3 Employees must not paste entire confidential documents, contracts, or client deliverables into AI tools without first reviewing the content for Restricted elements and removing or anonymizing them.

3.2.4 When using AI tools for code generation or review, source code containing hardcoded credentials, client-specific data, or unpublished proprietary algorithms must not be submitted to AI tools that operate outside the company's controlled environment.

3.2.5 Employees must be aware that many consumer AI services use submitted prompts and content to train their models. Only tools with verified enterprise terms that prohibit training on customer data are approved (see 3.1.2). Using consumer-tier AI with company data violates this policy even if the output is discarded.

3.3 Prohibited AI Tool Uses

The following uses of AI tools are prohibited at Summit IT Services:

3.3.1 Consumer AI services for company data: Using personal accounts on consumer-grade AI platforms (ChatGPT free/Plus, Google Gemini personal, Claude.ai personal, Midjourney personal, etc.) to process any non-Public company or client data. Enterprise-licensed equivalents of these tools may be approved separately.

3.3.2 AI-generated content without review: Publishing, sending to clients, or submitting AI-generated content (documents, code, emails, analysis) as the final product without human review, verification, and editing. AI outputs are starting points, not finished work.

3.3.3 Misrepresentation: Submitting AI-generated content as original human work where the audience would expect disclosure (e.g., training certifications, HR-required assessments, academic programs, RFP responses that require original methodology).

3.3.4 Deepfakes or synthetic media for deception: Using AI image, video, or voice generation tools to create synthetic media that misrepresents people, events, or company positions.

3.3.5 Bypassing security or compliance controls: Using AI tools to help circumvent security policies, generate malware, analyze vulnerabilities in systems without authorization, or assist in social engineering attacks.

3.3.6 Automated decision-making about individuals without human oversight: Using AI tools to make, or directly inform final decisions about, hiring, performance management, discipline, or access control without documented human review and approval of the decision.

3.3.7 Shadow AI procurement: Signing up for AI tools using personal payment methods or unauthorized SaaS on behalf of the company. Follow the SaaS approval process in POL-007.

3.4 Responsible Use and Output Quality

3.4.1 AI outputs must be treated as drafts requiring human review. Employees are responsible for the accuracy, quality, and appropriateness of all work they submit or deliver, regardless of whether AI was used in its creation.

3.4.2 AI tools can produce factually incorrect information with apparent confidence ("hallucinations"). Employees must independently verify any factual claims, legal statements, technical specifications, or numerical data generated by AI tools before relying on them.

3.4.3 AI-generated code must be reviewed for: - Correctness and security vulnerabilities (OWASP Top 10, injection flaws, etc.). - License compatibility for any code patterns that may be derived from training data. - Alignment with Summit IT Services coding standards and architecture. Code review by a peer engineer is required before merging AI-generated code into production repositories.

3.4.4 Employees should document their use of AI tools in work products where disclosure is appropriate (e.g., in internal document metadata, in code comments, or in client-facing work per client agreement terms). When in doubt, disclose.

3.5 AI Meeting Tools and Consent

3.5.1 AI-powered meeting summary and transcription tools (e.g., Zoom AI Companion) must only be activated in meetings where all participants have been notified and consented.

3.5.2 At the start of any recorded or AI-transcribed meeting, the host must state: "This meeting is being recorded and AI transcription is active. Please indicate in the chat if you do not consent." Participants who object must be accommodated by disabling the AI feature or allowing them to leave.

3.5.3 External parties (clients, vendors, candidates) must be explicitly informed before the meeting that AI transcription will be in use. This notification should be included in the calendar invite.

3.5.4 AI meeting summaries containing Internal or Confidential content must be shared only with attendees and relevant stakeholders via SharePoint or Teams, not via public links.

3.6 Intellectual Property and Copyright

3.6.1 Employees must be aware that AI-generated content may not be protectable by copyright in all jurisdictions and that training data may expose Summit IT Services to copyright infringement claims. Do not represent AI-generated text, images, or code as proprietary Summit IT Services intellectual property without legal review.

3.6.2 Client contracts may have specific provisions about AI use in deliverables. Employees must review client agreement terms or consult Legal before using AI tools for client-billable work.

3.6.3 AI tools must not be used to reproduce substantial portions of copyrighted works (books, articles, code from non-permissive open source projects) in company outputs.

3.7 Training and Awareness

3.7.1 All employees must complete the mandatory "Responsible AI Use at Summit IT Services" training module (available in the LMS) within 30 days of this policy's effective date and annually thereafter.

3.7.2 IT Security will publish an AI Use FAQ and approved tool guides at <https://help.summitit.com/ai-tools>. This resource is updated when new tools are approved or guidance changes.

3.7.3 Questions about whether a specific AI use case is permitted should be directed to the IT Service Desk ([#it-help](#)) or to IT Security (soc@summitit.com for data handling questions).

4. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
All Employees	Use only approved AI tools; apply data classification rules to all AI inputs; review AI outputs before use; complete annual AI training; report concerns to IT
Managers	Ensure team awareness of this policy; review team use of AI tools; confirm client contract AI provisions before team uses AI on client work
IT Security & Compliance	Own policy; maintain approved AI tool list; evaluate new AI tools; monitor for shadow AI; investigate data leakage incidents
L3 Engineering	Configure and manage approved AI tool integrations (Copilot, GitHub Copilot); monitor telemetry; enforce approved tool lists via DLP
Legal	Advise on copyright, IP, and regulatory implications of AI use; review client contract AI provisions; advise on AI regulatory developments
HR	Ensure mandatory AI training completion; partner with IT on AI-related disciplinary matters
Finance	Approve AI tool procurements; manage AI SaaS contracts

5. Enforcement & Consequences

5.1 Microsoft Purview DLP policies are configured to detect and block uploads of Restricted data patterns to AI tool endpoints where technically feasible.

5.2 Policy violations:

- **Using consumer AI with Internal data (first occurrence):** Mandatory training; written warning.
- **Using consumer AI with Confidential data:** Formal written warning; potential HR action; investigation of data exposure.
- **Entering Restricted data into any AI tool:** Immediate incident response; HR investigation; data breach assessment; potential termination.
- **Shadow AI procurement:** Software removed; written warning; repeated violations treated as serious misconduct.
- **Submitting AI-generated work as human-original in prohibited contexts:** HR investigation; disciplinary action up to termination.

6. Exceptions

Exceptions (e.g., a business case for using an AI tool with Restricted data in a controlled, legally reviewed context) require:

1. Formal AI Tool Exception Request via SummitDesk.
2. IT Security data security assessment.
3. Legal privacy and IP review.
4. CISO and General Counsel approval.
5. Defined data minimization and output controls.
6. Exception reviewed quarterly.

7. Related Documents

- POL-001 - Acceptable Use Policy
- POL-005 - Data Classification & Handling Policy
- POL-007 - Software Installation & Licensing Policy
- POL-008 - Email & Communications Policy
- REF-0001 - Summit IT Environment Standards
- Approved AI Tools Catalog (<https://help.summitit.com/catalog/ai-tools>)
- Responsible AI Use Training (LMS)

8. Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	2024-10-01	IT Security & Compliance	Initial policy release; aligned to M365 Copilot and GitHub Copilot Business approvals

1.1	2025-04-15	IT Security & Compliance	Added Microsoft Copilot for Security; updated consumer AI prohibition; added copyright/IP section
1.2	2026-06-01	IT Security & Compliance	Annual review; updated approved tool table; added shadow AI DLP enforcement note; expanded AI meeting consent requirements